



Amir Anderson Animator Toolkit

Animate faster and learn as you go — a toolkit panel for After Effects.

User Guide

by Amir Anderson · Version 1.0

1 · Start Guide

What's in This Download

- **Amir_Anderson_Animator_Toolkit.zxp** — the plugin. This is the only file you need to install.
- **Animator_Toolkit_Quick_Start_Guide.pdf** — this document.
- **Amir_Anderson_Animator_Toolkit.zip** — optional: the same plugin with install scripts, for installing without a ZXP installer.
- **LICENSE.txt** — usage terms.

What It Does

Animator Toolkit puts everyday animation jobs one click away: setting anchor points, adding keyframes, easing, ready-made entrances and exits, text animation, masks, 3D, cameras, fast previews, audio fades and still grabs. Every button tells you what it did, and short lessons explain the “why” as you go.

Everything it changes is a normal After Effects edit: one click is one undo, and your layers stay fully editable in the timeline.

Requirements

- Adobe After Effects 2021 (18.0) or later
- macOS or Windows

Install (about two minutes)

1. Install a ZXP installer app once — **ZXP Installer** (aescripts.com/learn/zxp-installer, recommended) or **Anastasiy's Extension Manager** (install.anastasiy.com). A .zxp is Adobe's package format for extensions; this small free app opens it.
2. Open the installer, drag **Amir_Anderson_Animator_Toolkit.zxp** into it, and click **Install**.
3. If a one-time “unverified developer” notice appears, click through it — the plugin is signed, just not through Adobe's paid developer program. On macOS: **System Settings** → **Privacy & Security** → **Open Anyway**. On Windows: **More info** → **Run anyway**.
4. **Fully quit** After Effects (Cmd+Q / File → Exit) and reopen it.

5. Open **Window** → **Extensions** → **Amir Anderson Animator Toolkit**. The panel docks like any other AE panel.

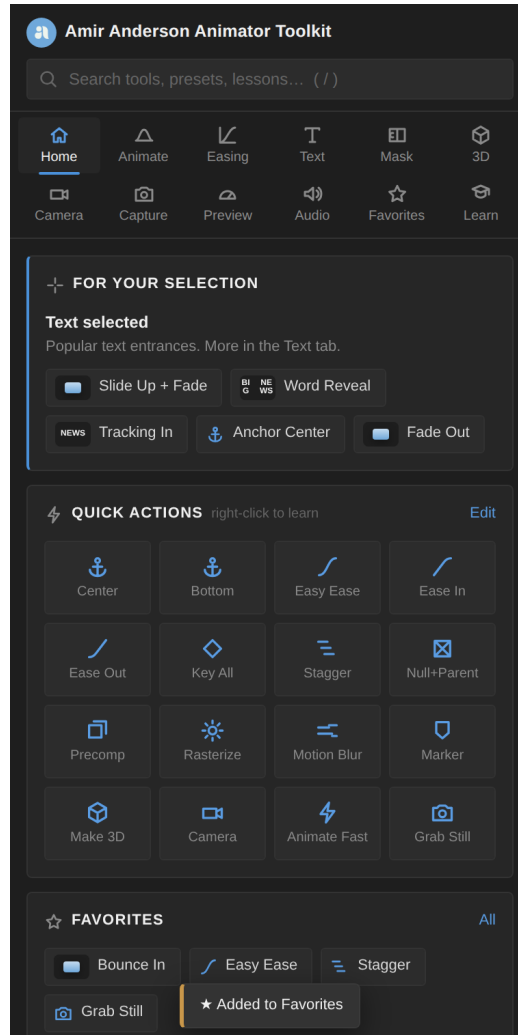
Your First Animation (60 seconds)

1. Select a layer in your comp's timeline.
2. Open the **Animate** tab and make sure **Entrance** is chosen.
3. Click **Slide Up + Fade**. The layer now slides up and fades in, with real keyframes you can edit.
4. Press **Spacebar** in After Effects to play it.

Changed your mind? **Cmd+Z** (Mac) / **Ctrl+Z** (Windows) undoes it in one step — or click **Undo** on the message the panel shows.

2 · The Interface

The panel has a title bar with your **Search** box, a row of **tabs** (one per kind of job), and the tools for the tab you're on. The **Home** tab suggests tools for whatever you have selected.



The panel, open on the Home tab.

The Tabs

Tab	What it's for
Home	Suggestions for your selection, your Quick actions, and the 5 essential skills.
Animate	Anchor points, align, keyframes, Stagger, and the entrance and exit library.
Easing	Easy Ease, ease in and out, curve presets, bounce, elastic and overshoot.
Text	New text, plus animations by letter, word or line.
Mask	Animated wipes and reveals, and mask tools.
3D	Make layers 3D, spread them in depth, and extruded 3D text.
Camera	Create a camera, then push, pull, orbit, shake and focus.
Capture	Grab Still: save the current frame as a PNG.
Preview	Animate Fast and Final Check setups, and faster previews.
Audio	Levels and fades for audio layers.
Favorites	Your own kit of the tools you use most.
Learn	Short lessons, quick fixes and explained shortcuts.

Getting Help Inside the Panel

- **Hover** over any button to see what it does.
- **Right-click** a tool to learn what it needs and why it's useful.
- If a button needs something (for example, a selected layer), the message tells you exactly what to select.

3 · Tab by Tab

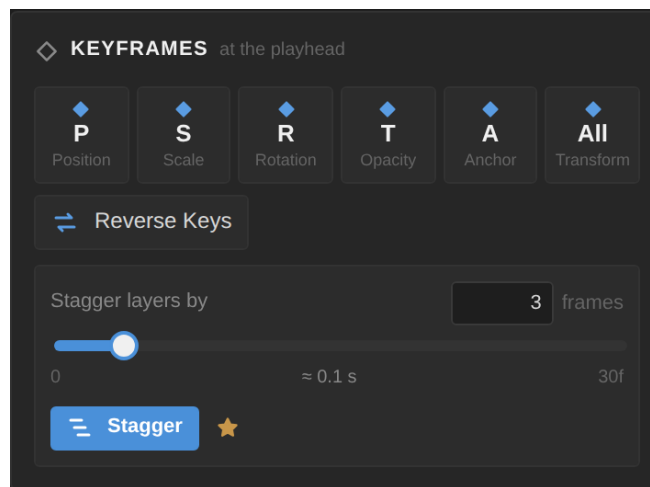
You don't need to learn every tab at once. These are the ones you'll use most.

Animate

Anchor Point: click a dot on the grid to move a layer's anchor without the layer jumping.

Keyframes: add a keyframe for Position, Scale, Rotation, Opacity or all of them at the playhead.

Stagger: offset the selected layers by a number of frames so they animate one after another.

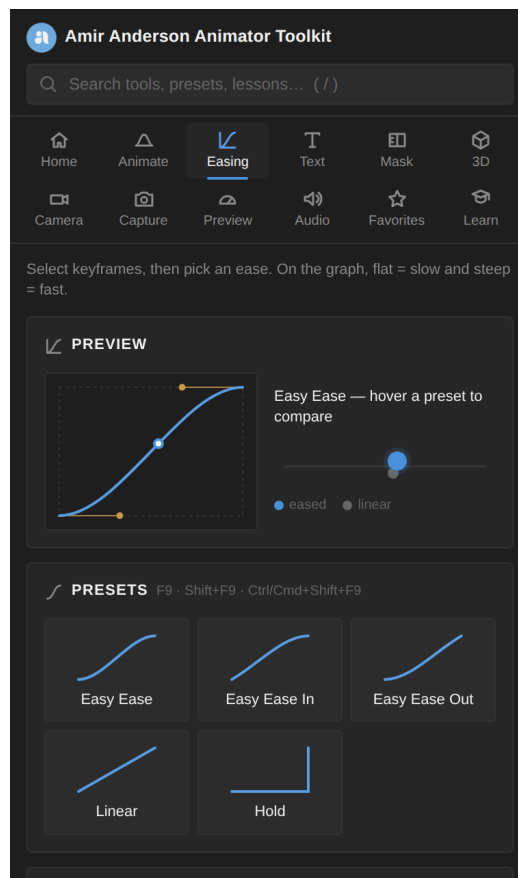


Keyframe buttons and Stagger, set in frames.

Below that is the **Motion** library. Pick **Entrance** or **Exit**, then click a tile. Hover a tile to preview it first.

Easing

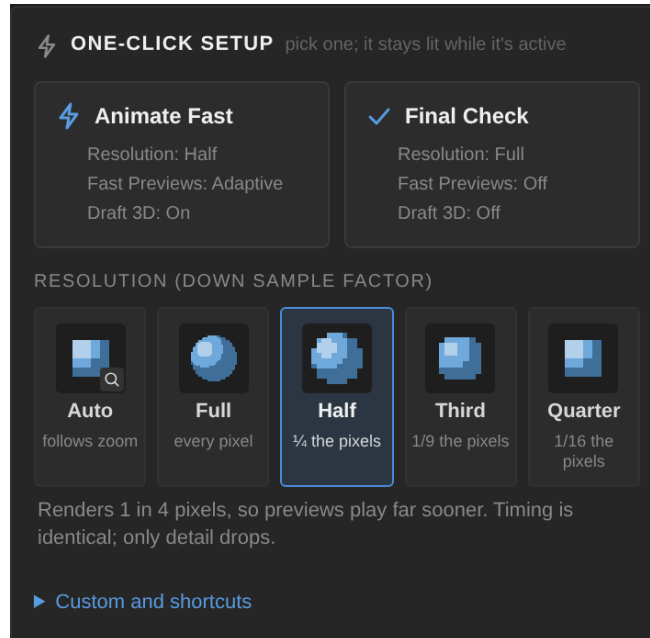
Select two or more keyframes, then click **Easy Ease**, **Ease In** or **Ease Out**. The live curve shows the shape of the motion, and the physics buttons add real bounce, elastic or overshoot keyframes.



The live curve: blue is eased, gray is linear.

Preview

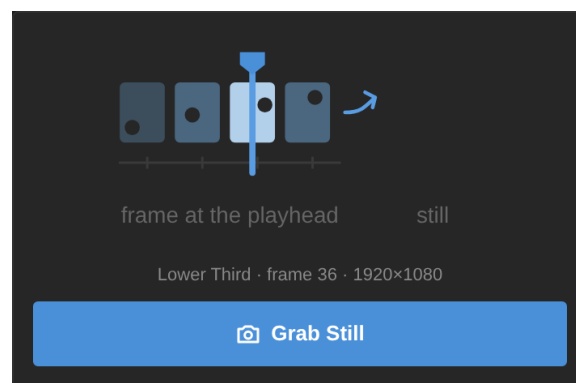
Click **Animate Fast** while you work for smooth, real-time playback (lower resolution, same timing). Click **Final Check** before you render to see every pixel at full quality. The resolution cards switch between Auto, Full, Half, Third and Quarter.



One-click setup and the resolution cards.

Capture

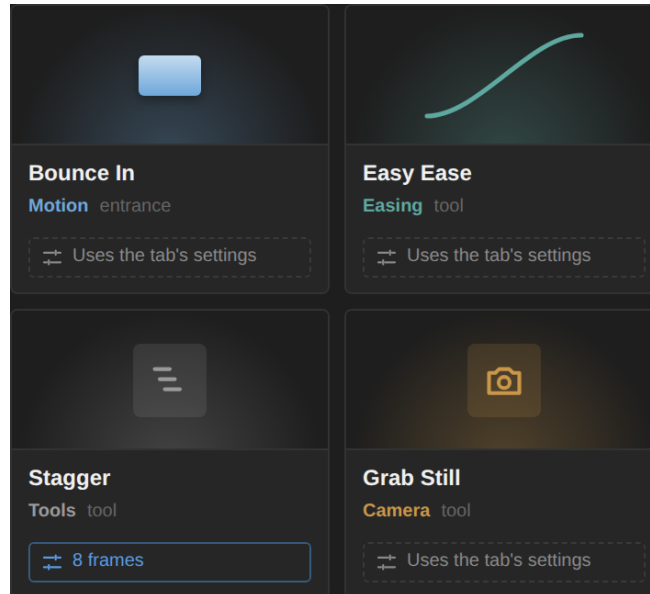
Click **Grab Still** to save the frame at the playhead as a PNG. A pop-up shows the image and where it was saved. Turn on **Import into project** to add it to your Project panel too.



Grab Still saves the frame under the playhead.

Favorites

Click the **star** icon on any tool, preset or lesson to add it here. Click a card to use it. Click the settings button on a card to give that favorite **its own settings** — for example, Stagger by 8 frames — without changing the tab it came from.



Favorites, with Stagger saved at 8 frames.

Learn

Short lessons (under two minutes each) on the essentials, animation principles and production tips, plus **Quick fixes** for common problems and a list of **shortcuts** explained in plain words. Many lessons have a **Try it** button that runs the tool for you.

4 · A Fast Animation Workflow

Here's a simple way to go from still layers to smooth, finished motion using the panel.

1. **Set up for speed.** In **Preview**, click **Animate Fast** so playback stays real-time while you work.
2. **Fix the anchor point.** Select your layers and, in **Animate**, click a dot on the anchor grid.
3. **Add motion.** Click an **Entrance** tile such as Slide Up + Fade, or add your own keyframes with the **Keyframes** buttons.
4. **Shape the timing.** Select the keyframes and click **Easy Ease** in **Easing**. Want more life? Try **Overshoot** or **Bounce**.
5. **Stagger it.** Select several layers and click **Stagger** so they come in one after another.
6. **Check it.** Before rendering, click **Final Check** in **Preview** to see full quality.
7. **Share a frame.** Click **Grab Still** in **Capture** to send a quick approval image.

Tips for a Clean Workflow

- Star the tools you use every day so they're waiting in **Favorites** and on **Home**.
- Timing is in **frames**, with the seconds shown underneath, so it matches your timeline.

Keyboard Shortcuts

- **/** — jump to Search: find any tool, preset, lesson or shortcut by name.
- **Esc** — close Search or any pop-up.
- **Cmd/Ctrl+Z** — native After Effects undo.

Troubleshooting

- **Plugin doesn't appear under Window → Extensions** — fully quit and reopen After Effects (not just close a project).
- **Nothing happens when you double-click the .zxp** — install ZXP Installer or Anastasiy's Extension Manager first, then open the .zxp through that app.
- **macOS says it can't verify the developer** — System Settings → Privacy & Security → Open Anyway.

Questions or feedback — Amir Anderson · [linkedin.com/in/amiranderson](https://www.linkedin.com/in/amiranderson)

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